

OE3C Planning Meeting 7

Date: 22 Jan 2026

Location: Online

Time: 11:01 AM – 12:03 PM

Attendees: Lyllian Corbin, Alex Wilder, Reem Mahamoud, Sarah Hein, Nicholas Benton, Matthew Summerville, Madelaine Legault, Cassia Hamilton, Wylan Clitheroe, Lauren Nesbitt, Harry Kumbhani, Kiyoko Gotanda, Katherine Yagi

Chair: Alex Wilder

Minutes by: Lyllian Corbin

[Recap: OE3C Standing Meeting time Thursday, January 22 | Meeting | Microsoft Teams](#)

Meeting started at 11:01 AM.

Call to Order and Approval of Minutes

- Meeting minutes approved

Workshops and Outings Discussion with Wylan, Nick, and Madelaine

- The group met last Monday to discuss workshops
- Wylan's discussion on **guided hikes**
 - o Planning a 2 hr hike in the afternoon on arrival day for the conference (Apr 30th)
 - Re-wilding themed hike – Wylan is working on the outline now
 - Theme writing, script, hike stops, researching information for each hike stop
 - Planned to finish tasks by reading week
 - Mindfulness hike on the Bruce trail
 - ~30 mins walking and ~15 mins to come back
 - o Hike sections are now included on the rough schedule on Teams
- Nick's discussion on **workshops**
 - o Moved some things around in the schedule
 - o Planned 2 workshops on Day 1 of the conference
 - Photography workshop with Kiyoko – 2 hr session

- Will need a maximum cap and sign up for the workshop
 - Coding with comp sci student
 - Looking to book a computer lab
- Planned 1 workshop on Day 2
 - First nations ecological talk
- Back up option for the hikes
 - Scavenger hunt around Mac Chown building
- Madelaine mentioned the Photography Competition that will run throughout the conference
 - Need to discuss categories for the competition
 - Landscape
 - Animals/ecology
 - Madelaine will send out a poll
 - Alex suggested starting with the 3 E's
 - Platform for hosting photo competition to store photos (will cost \$\$ but we have the budget for it)
 - Information can be found in the Teams folder for outings and socials
 - Alex asked to clarify the purpose of the platform (voting and displaying? Can we use Microsoft?)
 - Madelaine explained the platform would be used for submissions, voting, and displaying photos in a presentation
 - Alex agreed that this option is possible, but it might be more work on our end to track everything
- Madelaine's discussion on **outings**
 - Wine Tasting through CCOVI
 - Madelaine asked Alex if we can reach out to schedule the wine outing
 - Outing for Saturday, May 2nd (Day 2)
 - Scheduled for 6 pm on May 1st in Niagara Falls
 - Suggestion to reach out to the Brock community to display art for the silent auction
 - Reaching out to local artists
 - Alex suggested including people from the conference in the auction
- Alex: Margarita has opened her bar "Siris Tasting Room"
 - Could be an option for socials/outings

- Regarding concerns for where people can store items if they arrive early in the morning
 - Alex suggested we use a seminar room as a coat check room for morning registrations (for people who arrive before the 3 pm check in time)
 - Madelaine is not sure how many people will be present for a morning hike due to travel times
 - Nick is concerned with the timing of workshops and the number of people coming to each workshop
 - Alex suggested to ask Harry for further input on the workshops

Keynote Update with Harry

- Confirmed the Evolution keynote – Nancy Chen
 - Harry will give an image to Rasa to put on the website
- Jesse Popp needs a week or 2 to decide (she's on sabbatical right now)
- Harry hasn't heard back from Maydianne yet
 - Kiyoko suggested that Harry follow up with Maydianne to confirm

Conference Schedule Updates

- Wylan updated the schedule to include hikes and an Indigenous workshop
- The awards ceremony and banquet will be pushed down by an hour
 - Need to include poster preview earlier in the day
 - Alex suggested letting the poster preview overlap with the mindfulness hike in the morning
- Alex asked for feedback to be sent in before Jan 28th

Registration (Cassia's notes)

- Reem needs to follow up with Lucas about registration information that needs to be included
- Lunch is currently included in the registration prices
 - We need to discuss if breakfast will also be included in the registration cost – this will depend on what options we have for breakfast (e.g., if we are using Brock's catering for breakfast, need to figure out costs as well)
- Edits for the registration page
 - Change theme to "Coexisting within Nature"

- Provide full name of conference for consistency (i.e. Ontario Ecology, Ethology, and Evolution Colloquium)
- Reem asked about adding workshops to the registration page
 - Kiyoko suggested leaving that section as “coming soon” to give people time to make up their minds
- Reem asked about including the banquet on the registration page
 - The banquet cost is TBD – there should be an approximate idea of costs by the next meeting
- We will need a subcommittee meeting to discuss swag items and how much we will sell the items for
 - This can also be included on the registration page on a later date

Social Media and Website Update

- Sarah provided website updates on Rasa’s behalf
 - Main updates
 - Campus accessibility page needs feedback
 - Sarah discussed putting a map and including the prayer/smudging room (contact: mkuzak@brocku.ca)
 - Fixed spelling errors and updated logo
 - Schedule page is TBD, this page will be updated once the schedule is finalised
 - Matthew spoke to Rasa about fixing blurriness in the images
 - Campus eatery page has typos that need to be fixed
 - Construction has started on Isaac’s so this location should not be included on the webpage
 - Madelaine suggested that the vinery and winery tours needs to be removed from excursion info and change to “activity information” to include the workshop and outings info
 - Sarah suggested also replacing the vineyard photo
 - Alex suggested using the wine library photo instead
 - Lillian brought up concerns about limited hours for campus eating spots
 - Alex explained that Brock Dining confirmed they can open places or extend their hours for us if we let them know in advance
- Matthew did not have any major updates for the social media pages
 - Matt asked everyone to reach out to him for any ideas/facts they want to share on the socials

Announcement Flyer Update with Lauren

- Flyer was completed
 - o Lauren asked everyone to send any feedback
 - o The flyer can also be included on the socials
 - o Kiyoko commented on replacing the cursive font in case people can't read cursive
- Lauren will include the updated flyer in the Files channel on Teams
- Lauren asked about sending mass emails for communications
 - o Kiyoko will meet with Lauren to talk more about that
 - There is a spreadsheet of contacts in Teams (under Files and Documents > Fundraising subfolder)
 - o Kiyoko explained that mass communication emails should be sent out through the OE3C official gmail, or Kiyoko can send them on Lauren's behalf

Banquet Discussion

- Cassia will help chair the banquet team
- We need to figure out the banquet logistics
 - o Kiyoko asked when and where the banquet will be held
 - Saturday evening, initial location was the Pond Inlet
 - Kiyoko suggested holding the banquet in Market as there will be more space for everyone and for the food

Meeting adjourned at 12:03 PM.